

Transforming Health Needs Assessments: Reproducible Insights for Smarter NHS Planning

How robust analysis of population health data can inform NHS
commissioning, planning and service design

Purpose



Influencing Planning

Guide commissioning and service design with data-driven insights.



Driving Health Equity

Target interventions to reduce inequalities and improve outcomes.



Resource Allocation

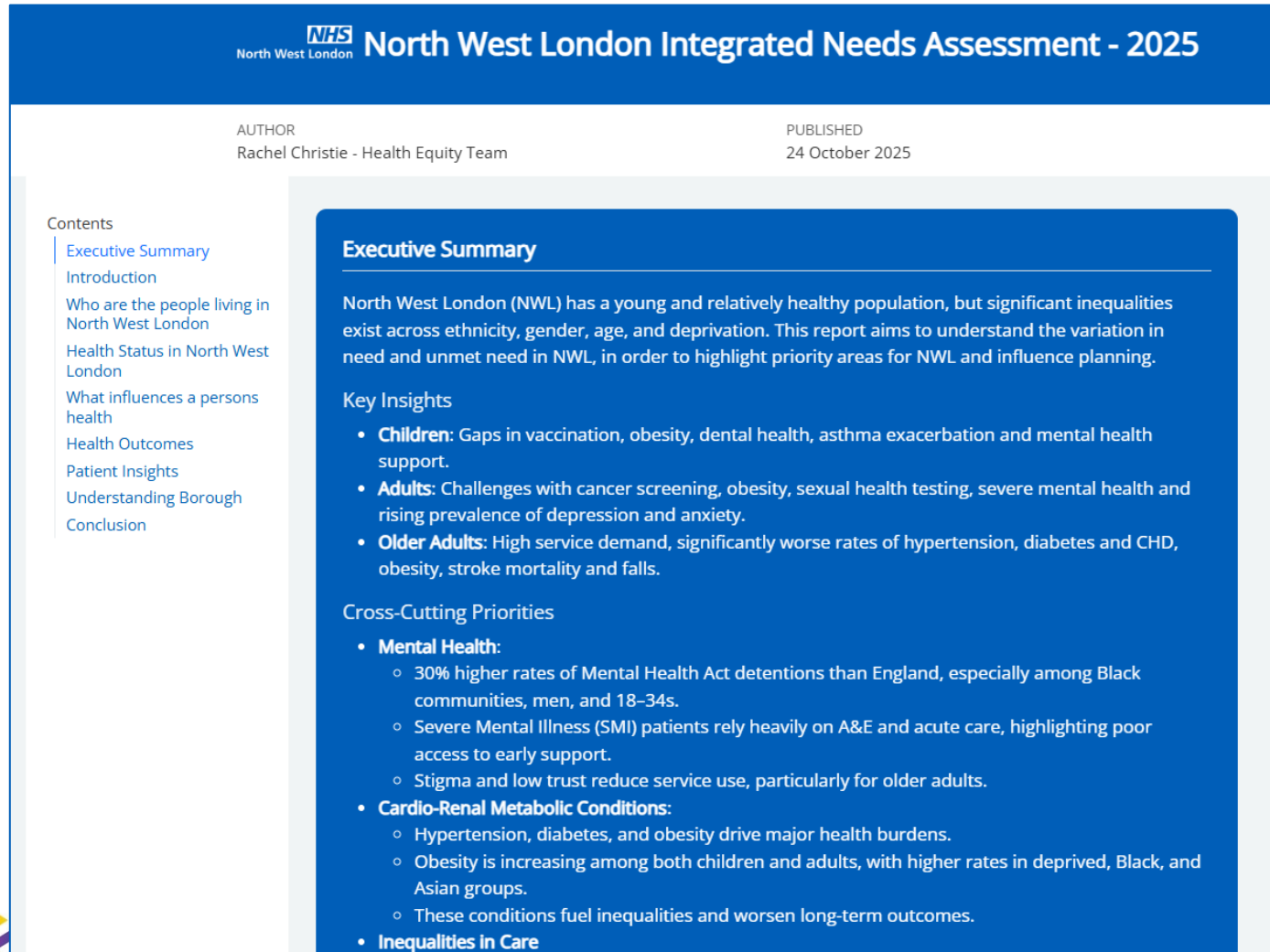
Allocate resources where they will have the most impact.



Focusing on Prevention

Emphasize proactive, preventative approaches to population health.

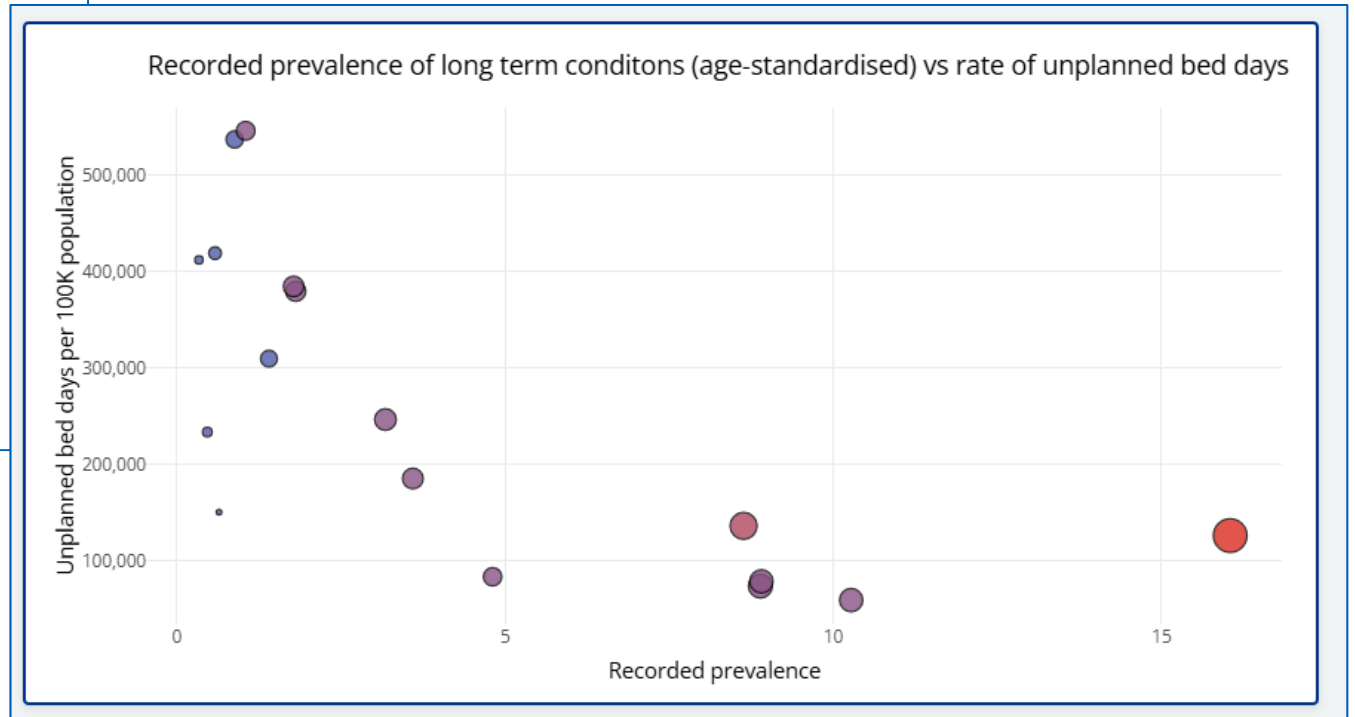
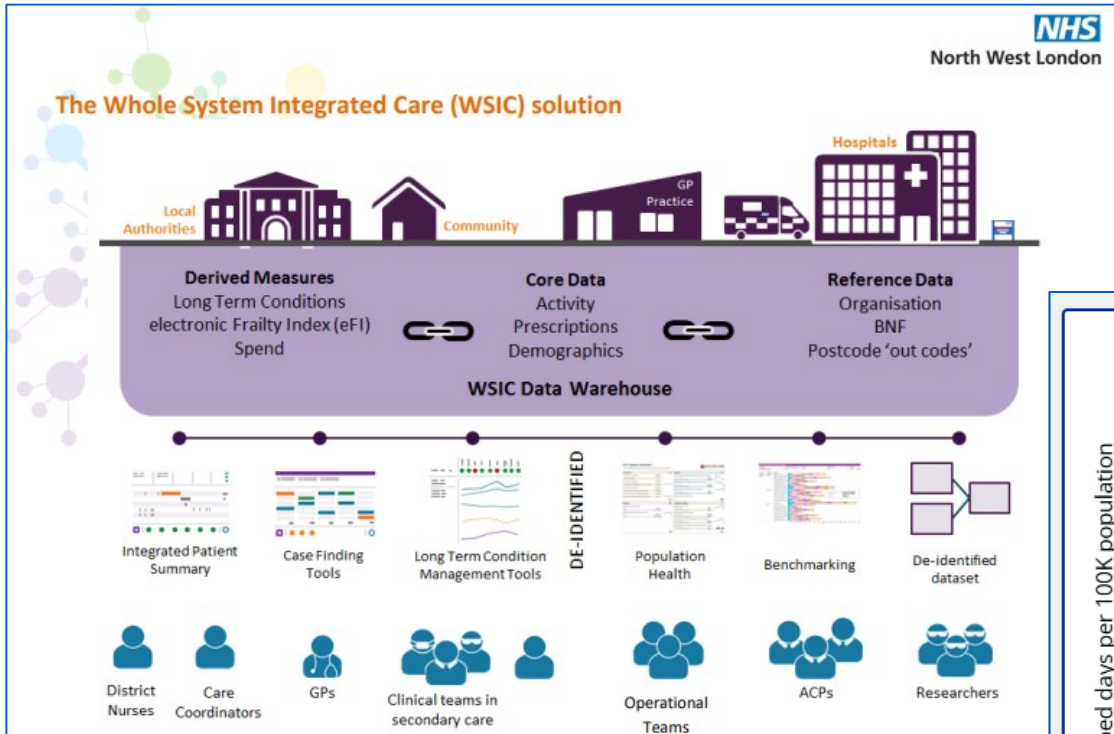
What makes a good needs assessment?



NWL Integrated Needs Assessment 2025

- Comprehensive Scope
- Multitude of Data Sources
- **Linked data**
- Focus on variation
- **Framework for prioritization**
- Inclusion of Patient Insights
- **Interactive and engaging**
- **Reproducibility**

Linked Data



Framework for prioritisation

Contents

[Executive Summary](#)

[Introduction](#)

[Who are the people living in North West London](#)

[Health Status in North West London](#)

[What influences a persons health](#)

[Health Outcomes](#)

[Long term conditons](#)

[Areas of unmet need](#)

[Patient Insights](#)

[Understanding Borough](#)

[Conclusion](#)

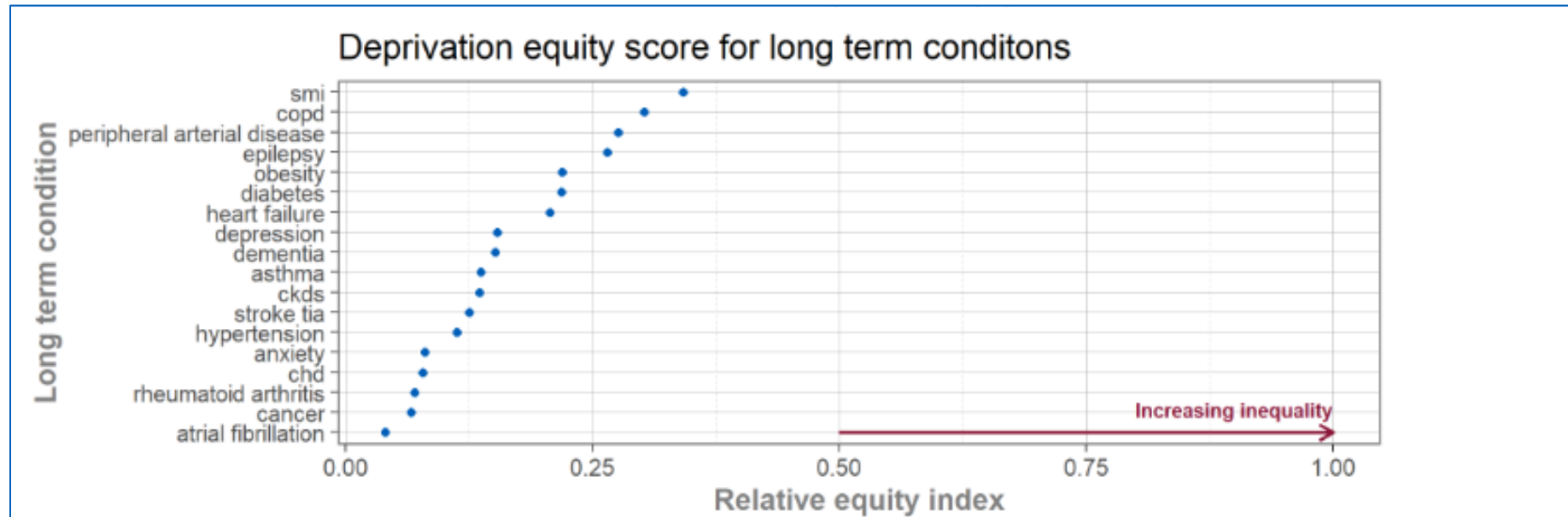
Taking recorded prevalence, impact on the person and system (represented by unplanned bed days) and inequality across deprivations groups into consideration the long term conditions in which should be considered a priority in NWL are hypertension, diabetes, obesity, COPD and heart failure.

LTC	Recorded prevalence (%) (WSIC)	Unplanned bed days (per 100K population)	Deprivation Inequalities score	Worse than England
Diabetes	8.6	135,900	0.21	Yes
Hypertension	16.0	125,800	0.11	No
Obesity	8.9	78,200	0.22	No
COPD	1.4	309,300	0.30	No
Heart failure	1.0	545,700	0.21	No

Framework for prioritisation

Equity Index

The equity index numerically measures variation inequality across demographic groups. A score of 0 represents complete equity, while a score of 1 indicates total inequity. Each indicator's average relative deviation is calculated against the mean for different characteristic groupings (eg. gender, ethnicity and deprivation). Only statistically meaningful differences are considered in the Equity Index calculations.



Interactive and engaging



North West London Integrated Needs Assessment - 2025

AUTHOR
Rachel Christie - Health Equity Team

PUBLISHED
24 September 2025

Contents

- [Executive Summary](#)
- [Introduction](#)
- [Who are the people living in North West London](#)
- [Health Status in North West London](#)
- [What influences a persons health](#)
- [Health Outcomes](#)
- [Patient Insights](#)
- [Understanding Borough](#)
- [Conclusion](#)

Executive Summary

North West London (NWL) has a young and relatively healthy population, but significant inequalities exist across ethnicity, gender, age, and deprivation. This report aims to understand the variation in need and unmet need in NWL, in order to highlight priority areas for NWL and influence planning.

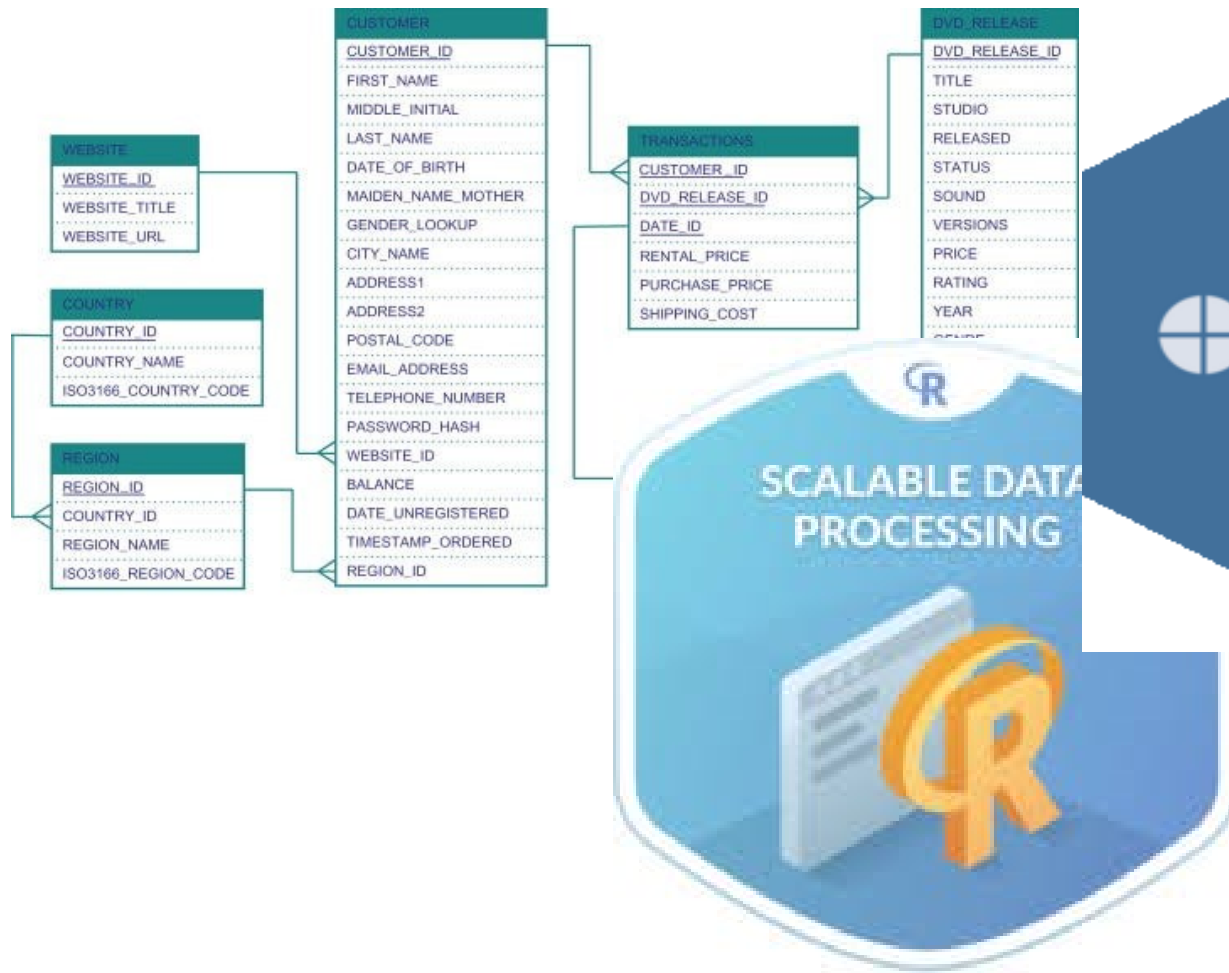
Key Insights

- **Children:** Gaps in vaccination, obesity, dental health, asthma exacerbation and mental health support.
- **Adults:** Challenges with cancer screening, obesity, sexual health testing, severe mental health and rising prevalence of depression and anxiety.
- **Older Adults:** High service demand, significantly worse rates of hypertension, diabetes and CHD, obesity, stroke mortality and falls.

Cross-Cutting Priorities

- **Mental Health:**
 - 30% higher rates of Mental Health Act detentions than England, especially among Black communities, men, and 18–34s.
 - Severe Mental Illness (SMI) patients rely heavily on A&E and acute care, highlighting poor access to early support.
 - Stigma and low trust reduce service use, particularly for older adults.
- **Cardio-Renal Metabolic Conditions:**
 - Hypertension, diabetes, and obesity drive major health burdens.
 - Obesity is increasing among both children and adults, with higher rates in deprived, Black, and Asian groups.
 - These conditions fuel inequalities and worsen long-term outcomes.
- **Inequalities in Care**

Reproducibility



```
Example.quarto.qmd  custom_style.c
Render on Save
Source Visual B I </> Normal
---
title: "Example quarto"
author: "Greg Martin"
format:
  html:
    css: custom_style.css
---
```


Impact

- Starting point for identifying ICB priorities
- Reference point for business cases
- Case for change for addressing inequalities
- Allows non-NHS partners to understand decision making